

CHAPTER 43.

An Act to provide for the Admission of Representatives
of the Press to the Meetings of certain Local Authorities.
[21st December 1908.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and
with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and
Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled,
and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1. Representatives of the press shall be admitted to the meetings of every local authority: Provided that a local authority may temporarily exclude such representatives from a meeting as often as may be desirable at any meeting when, in the opinion of a majority of the members of the local authority present at such meeting, expressed by resolution, in view of the special nature of the business then being dealt with or about to be dealt with, such exclusion is advisable in the public interest.

Representa-
tives of the
press to be ad-
mitted to the
meetings of a
local authority
subject to a
proviso.

2. For the purposes of this Act the expression "local authority" means—

Definitions

- (a) A council of a county, county borough, borough (including a metropolitan borough), urban district, rural district, or parish, and a joint committee or joint board of any two or more such councils to which any of the powers or duties of the appointing councils may have been transferred or delegated under the provisions of any Act of Parliament or Provisional Order; and a parish meeting under the provisions of the Local Government Act, 1894; 56 & 57 Vict. c. 73.
- (b) An education committee and a joint education committee, established under section seventeen of the Education Act, 1902, so far as respects any acts or proceedings which are not required to be submitted to the council or councils for its or their approval; 2 Edw. 7. c. 42.
- (c) A board of guardians, and a joint committee constituted in pursuance of section eight of the Poor Law Act, 1879, and the board of management of any school or asylum district formed under any of the Acts relating to the relief of the poor; 42 & 43 Vict. c. 54.
- (d) A central body and a distress committee under the Unemployed Workmen Act, 1905; 5 Edw. 7. c. 18.
- (e) The Metropolitan Water Board and a joint water board constituted under the provisions of any Act of Parliament or Provisional Order;
- (f) Any other local body which has, or may hereafter have, the power to make a rate.

The expression "rate" means a rate the proceeds of which are applicable to public local purposes, and leviable on the basis

of an assessment in respect of property, and includes any sum which, though obtained in the first instance by a precept, certificate, or other document requiring payment from some authority or officer, is or can be ultimately raised out of a rate.

The expression "representatives of the press" means duly accredited representatives of newspapers and duly accredited representatives of news agencies which systematically carry on the business of selling and supplying reports and information to newspapers.

Saving for committee meetings.

3. This Act shall not extend to any meeting of a committee of a local authority, as defined for the purposes of this Act, unless the committee is itself such an authority.

Powers of committee.

4. Nothing in this Act shall be construed so as to prohibit a committee of a local authority from admitting representatives of the press to its meetings.

Admission of the public.

5. Nothing in this Act shall be construed so as to prohibit a local authority from admitting the public to its meetings.

Application to Scotland.

6. In the application of this Act to Scotland—

(1) The expression "local authority" means—

(a) a county council, a town council, a parish council, a school board, and a district committee constituted under the Local Government (Scotland) Acts;

(b) a central body and a distress committee under the Unemployed Workmen Act, 1905;

(c) any other local body, board, joint board, or committee which has or may hereafter have the power to impose a rate as defined in section two of this Act, and which does not require to report its proceedings to any other local authority;

(2) The definition of the expression "local authority," in section two of this Act, shall not apply to Scotland.

Short title and extent.

7.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Local Authorities (Admission of the Press to Meetings) Act, 1908.

(2) This Act shall not extend to Ireland.

CHAPTER 44.

An Act to regulate the turning out upon Commons of Entire Animals. [21st December 1908.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows: